

HOT

1. Passage anchor

> “It was a **hot** Saturday afternoon.”

Passage meaning

hot = having a high temperature; very warm

熱的；**炎熱的**

Here, **hot** describes the weather on that Saturday afternoon.

Practice

1. It was a **hot** summer afternoon.

那是一個**炎熱的**夏日下午。

2. The weather became extremely **hot** by midday.

到了中午，天氣變得非常**炎熱**。

Core meanings of HOT

2. hot — high temperature

= having a high temperature

熱的；**高溫的**

Examples

1. The soup is still **hot**.

湯仍然很**熱**。

2. Be careful—the pan is **hot**.

小心，平底鍋很**燙**。

This is the central literal sense.

3. hot — weather

= having very warm or high-temperature weather

炎熱的

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. It gets very **hot** here in summer.
這裡夏天非常**炎熱**。
2. We stayed indoors during the **hot** afternoon.
那個**炎熱的**下午我們待在室內。

4. hot food / drink

= food or drink served at a high temperature
熱的食物 / 飲品

Examples

1. I'd like a **hot drink**.
我想要一杯**熱飲**。
2. The café serves **hot food** all day.
這家咖啡店全天供應**熱食**。

Spicy

5. hot — spicy

= containing chili or spices that create a burning sensation in the mouth
辣的 ; 辛辣的

Examples

1. This curry is very **hot**.
這個咖喱非常**辣**。
2. I don't usually eat **hot food**.
我通常不吃太**辣的食物**。

This is a major learner trap because **hot food** can mean either:

* **熱食**

* **辣的食物**

Context decides.

6. hot sauce

= spicy sauce, usually containing chili

辣醬

Examples

1. Add a little **hot sauce**.

加一點**辣醬**。

2. This **hot sauce** is extremely spicy.

這種**辣醬**非常辣。

Popular / fashionable / trending

7. hot — currently very popular

= fashionable, popular, or receiving a lot of attention

熱門的；當紅的；受熱捧的

Examples

1. That restaurant is really **hot** right now.

那家餐廳現在非常**熱門**。

2. She is one of the **hottest** young actors in the industry.

她是業界目前最**當紅**的年輕演員之一。

8. hot topic

= subject currently attracting a lot of attention or debate

熱門話題；熱議議題

Examples

1. Artificial intelligence is a **hot topic**.

人工智能是一個**熱門話題**。

2. Housing has become a **hot political topic**.

房屋問題已成為一個**熱議議題**。

9. hot item / hot product

= product currently very popular or in strong demand

熱門商品；搶手產品

Examples

1. The toy became a **hot item** before Christmas.

那款玩具在聖誕節前成了**搶手商品**。

2. This model is currently a **hot product**.

這個型號目前是**熱門產品**。

Intense / highly active

10. hot — intense or highly active

= involving a lot of activity, excitement, competition, or pressure

激烈的；活躍的；火熱的

Examples

1. Competition is **hot** in this market.

這個市場的競爭非常**激烈**。

2. The property market remained **hot**.

房地產市場仍然十分**火熱**。

11. hot market

= market with very strong demand and high activity

火熱市場；旺盛市場

Examples

1. Housing was selling quickly in a **hot market**.

在**火熱的市場**中，房屋很快便售出。

2. It is difficult for buyers in a **hot market**.

在**市場火熱**時，買家會較吃力。

Sexually attractive

12. hot — sexually attractive

Informal:

= physically or sexually attractive

性感的；很有吸引力的

Examples

1. Some people think he is really **hot**.

有些人覺得他非常**性感有魅力**。

2. She described the actor as **hot**.

她形容那位演員很**性感吸引**。

Informal and context-sensitive.

Angry / emotionally heated

13. hot — angry / emotionally intense

= angry, excited, or emotionally worked up

激動的；火大的

Usually appears in expressions or compounds rather than as a bare adjective.

Examples

1. The discussion became **heated** and tempers grew **hot**.

討論變得激烈，大家的情緒也越來越**激動**。

2. He was still **hot with anger**.

他仍然**怒火中燒**。

14. hot temper

= tendency to become angry quickly

****火爆脾氣；容易發怒的性格****

Examples

1. He has a ****hot temper****.

他脾氣很****火爆****。

2. Her ****hot temper**** sometimes causes problems.

她的****急躁火爆脾氣****有時會造成問題。

Stolen / illegal goods

15. hot — stolen

Informal:

= stolen and therefore risky to possess or sell

****贓物的；偷來的****

Examples

1. The police suspected the car was ****hot****.

警方懷疑那輛車是****贓車****。

2. He was trying to sell ****hot goods****.

他正試圖出售****贓物****。

Major slang sense.

16. hot goods / hot merchandise

= stolen property being sold illegally

****贓物；賊贓****

Examples

1. The shop was accused of handling ****hot goods****.

那家店被指處理**贓物**。

2. Police recovered several pieces of **hot merchandise**.
警方找回多件**賊贓**。

Wanted / dangerous / attracting police attention

17. hot — attracting unwanted attention

Informal:

= dangerous to keep/use because police or authorities may be looking for it or you
被盯上的；風險很高的

Examples

1. The car had become too **hot** to use.
那輛車已經太容易引起警方注意，**不能再安全使用**。
2. The area was getting **hot**, so they left.
那個地方開始變得**危險、容易被發現**，所以他們離開了。

Close to finding / guessing

18. hot — close to the answer or target

= very close to finding something or guessing correctly
很接近答案 / 目標的

Common in guessing games.

Examples

1. "Am I getting closer?" "Yes, you're **hot**."
「我是不是越來越接近了？」「對，你**很接近了**。」
2. You're getting **hotter**.
你**越來越接近答案了**。

Opposite:

> **cold**

> → 離答案 / 目標很遠

Strong lead / close pursuit

19. hot on someone's trail

= following someone closely and likely to catch/find them soon

****緊追不捨；快要追上****

Examples

1. The police were ****hot on his trail****.

警方正在****緊追他的行蹤****。

2. Reporters were ****hot on the trail**** of the story.

記者正在****緊追這條新聞線索****。

20. hot lead

= promising clue or piece of information likely to produce a result

****重要線索；很有希望的線索****

Examples

1. Detectives received a ****hot lead****.

探員收到了一條****重要而有希望的線索****。

2. The investigation finally produced a ****hot lead****.

調查終於找到一條****很有價值的線索****。

Very recent / fresh

21. hot off the press

= extremely recent; just published or produced

****剛剛出爐的；最新的****

Examples

1. Here is the report, ****hot off the press****.

這是**剛剛出爐的**報告。

2. The news is **hot off the press**.

這是**最新消息**。

Originally connected with freshly printed paper being warm.

Strong performance / winning streak

22. hot — performing extremely well

Informal, especially sport/games:

= currently having unusually strong success or form

狀態火熱的；手風很順的

Examples

1. The player has been **hot** all week.

那名球員這星期一直**狀態火熱**。

2. The team is **hot** right now.

球隊目前**勢頭很強**。

23. hot streak

= period of repeated success

連勝期；狀態火熱的一段時間

Examples

1. The team is on a **hot streak**.

球隊正處於**連勝熱潮**。

2. She continued her **hot streak** with another win.

她再次獲勝，延續了自己的**火熱狀態**。

Strong/urgent communication

24. hotline

= telephone/service providing direct or immediate assistance or communication

****熱線；專線****

Examples

1. Call the emergency ****hotline****.

致電緊急****熱線****。

2. The company operates a customer ****hotline****.

公司設有客戶****服務熱線****。

Lexicalized compound.

Dangerous / disputed area

25. hot spot / hotspot

A. place with especially high activity, danger, disease, conflict, etc.

****熱點；高風險地區****

B. popular or fashionable place

****熱門地點****

C. wireless internet access point

****Wi-Fi 熱點****

You already have ****spot**** mapped, so this compound should not be treated as a new ****spot**** sense, but it is a useful lexicalized ****hot**** family extension.

Under pressure / difficult position

26. hot seat

= position in which someone faces pressure, criticism, questioning, or responsibility

****壓力位置；被盤問 / 受批評的位置****

Examples

1. The manager is in the ****hot seat**** after the failure.

失敗後，經理正處於****備受壓力的位置****。

2. The interview put him in the ****hot seat****.

那場訪問令他****備受盤問****。

Trouble

27. in hot water

= in trouble or facing criticism/punishment

****惹上麻煩；陷入困境****

Examples

1. He is ****in hot water**** with his boss.

他惹惱了老闆，現在****有麻煩了****。

2. The mistake landed the company ****in hot water****.

那個錯誤令公司****陷入麻煩****。

Very high-value idiom.

Difficult controversial issue

28. hot potato

= controversial or difficult issue that nobody wants responsibility for

****燙手山芋；棘手爭議問題****

Examples

1. The issue became a political ****hot potato****.

這個問題成了政治上的****燙手山芋****。

2. Housing is a ****hot potato**** for local officials.

住房問題對地方官員而言是個****棘手問題****。

Act immediately

29. strike while the iron is hot

= act while conditions are favorable

****趁熱打鐵****

Examples

1. Interest is high, so we should ****strike while the iron is hot****.

現在大家興趣正濃，我們應該****趁熱打鐵****。

2. She decided to apply immediately and ****strike while the iron was hot****.

她決定馬上申請，****把握最佳時機****。

Angry / embarrassed

30. hot under the collar

= angry, upset, or embarrassed

****氣得發火；激動不已****

Examples

1. He got ****hot under the collar**** when questioned.

他被質問時變得****很激動 / 很火大****。

2. There's no need to get ****hot under the collar****.

沒必要這麼****動怒****。

Related forms

31. heat

A. physical thermal energy/high temperature

****熱；熱度****

1. The ****heat**** was intense.

****高溫****非常強烈。

B. pressure/intensity

****壓力；激烈程度****

2. The company is feeling the **heat** from competitors.

公司正在感受到競爭對手帶來的**壓力**。

32. heat — verb

= make something hotter

加熱

Examples

1. **Heat** the oven first.

先**預熱 / 加熱**焗爐。

2. The water was **heated** slowly.

水被慢慢**加熱**。

33. heated

A. made hot

加熱過的

B. angry/intense

激烈的；情緒激動的

1. They had a **heated argument**.

他們發生了一場**激烈的爭論**。

This is an important figurative family extension.

34. overheat

= become or make something excessively hot

過熱

Examples

1. The engine began to **overheat**.

引擎開始**過熱**。

2. Do not let the device **overheat**.

不要讓裝置**過熱**。

Key contrasts

35. hot vs warm

warm

= pleasantly or moderately hot

暖的；溫暖的

hot

= higher temperature, often potentially uncomfortable

熱的；炎熱的

Compare:

> warm tea

> 溫茶

> hot tea

> 熱茶

36. hot vs spicy

hot

can mean spicy in food contexts.

spicy

= containing strong spices; often but not always chili-hot

辛辣的；香料味濃的

Compare:

> hot curry

> 很辣的咖喱

> spicy curry

> 香料味濃 / 辛辣的咖喱

37. hot vs heated

****hot****

= literal high temperature, or various informal metaphorical senses

****heated****

= especially common for arguments/discussions becoming emotionally intense

****激烈的****

Compare:

> hot weather

> 炎熱天氣

> heated debate

> 激烈辯論

38. hot vs popular

****popular****

= liked by many people

****受歡迎的****

****hot****

= currently attracting intense interest or attention

****當紅 / 熱門的****

A classic product can remain popular for years without being “hot” at the moment.

39. hot vs stolen

When ****hot**** describes a car, jewelry, electronics, etc., criminal context may change the meaning completely:

> a ****hot car****

> → could mean a car that is physically hot

but in criminal slang:

> a ****hot car****

> → ****賊車 / 警方正在追查的車****

Context is essential.

Meaning map

The central physical concept of ****hot**** is:

****high temperature****

From this develop:

Passage

hot afternoon

→ ****炎熱的下午****

Food

hot soup

→ ****熱湯****

Spiciness

hot curry

→ ****辣咖喱****

Then metaphorically, high “heat” becomes high intensity:

Popularity

hot topic

→ ****熱門話題****

Market

hot market

→ ****火熱市場****

Attraction

hot person

→ ****性感吸引的人****

Anger

hot temper

→ **火爆脾氣**

Sports

hot streak

→ **火熱狀態**

Pursuit

hot on the trail

→ **緊追不捨**

And separate slang/conventional branches include:

Crime

hot goods

→ **贓物**

Guessing

you're getting hot

→ **快猜中了**

Trouble

in hot water

→ **惹上麻煩**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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hot — temperature	溫度很高的；熱的 / 燙的
hot — weather	天氣、氣候炎熱的
hot food/drink — temperature	溫度高的熱食 / 熱飲
hot — spicy	吃起來有灼熱感的；辣的
hot sauce	以辣椒等製成的辣醬
hot — popular	當下非常受歡迎、受關注的；熱門 / 當紅的
hot topic	目前受到大量關注 / 討論的熱門話題
hot item/product	目前需求很大、很搶手的商品

hot — intense/active	市場、競爭等非常活躍 / 激烈的	
hot market	需求與交易活動非常旺盛的市場	
hot — attractive	非正式：性感、很有吸引力的	
hot — angry/intense	情緒激動、憤怒的	
hot temper	容易迅速發怒的火爆脾氣	
hot — stolen	非正式：偷來、屬於贓物的	
hot goods	偷來並非法轉售的贓物	
hot — risky/wanted	容易引起警方 / 當局注意、風險很高的	
hot — guessing	已非常接近正確答案或目標	
hot on someone's trail	正緊追某人的行蹤，接近追上 / 找到	
hot lead	很有可能帶來突破的重要線索	
hot off the press	剛剛出版 / 公布；最新出爐的	
hot — strong performance	非正式：目前表現非常出色、狀態火熱的	
hot streak	一段連續成功 / 表現出色的時期	
hotline	提供直接、即時協助或聯絡的熱線 / 專線	
hot seat	面對強大壓力、批評或盤問的位置	
in hot water	陷入麻煩 / 受到責備	
hot potato	難以處理、富爭議而沒人想接手的燙手山芋	
strike while the iron is hot	趁時機最好時立即行動；趁熱打鐵	
hot under the collar	因憤怒、激動或尷尬而情緒升高	
heat — temperature	熱量 / 高溫	
heat — pressure/intensity	非正式：壓力或激烈程度	
heat — verb	把某物加熱	
heated — argument/emotion	爭論等非常激烈、情緒化的	
overheat	變得 / 使變得過熱	

Passage recap

> “It was a **hot Saturday afternoon**.”

Here:

hot = **having a high temperature; very warm**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **炎熱的**

* **很熱的**

Natural contextual translation:

那是一個炎熱的星期六下午。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****hot****

= ****having a high temperature, especially describing weather that feels very warm****

****熱的；炎熱的****

The major learner trap is that the same word changes sharply with context:

> ****hot coffee****

> → 熱咖啡

> ****hot curry****

> → 辣咖喱

> ****hot topic****

> → 熱門話題

> ****hot market****

> → 火熱市場

> ****hot actor****

> → 性感 / 當紅的演員，視語境而定

> ****hot goods****

> → 贓物

> ****you're getting hot****

> → 你快猜中了

> ****in hot water****

> → 惹上麻煩

So the passage uses the simplest literal ****temperature/weather**** branch, but ****hot**** has a very broad modern figurative network built around the ideas of ****heat, intensity, excitement, danger, and immediacy****.